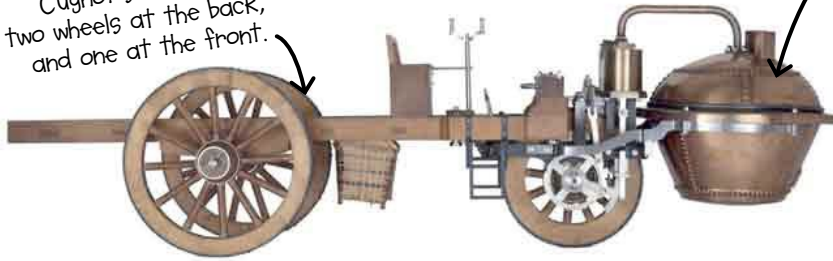


Steaming along

The first **automobile** was steam-powered, built by Frenchman Nicolas-Joseph Cugnot in 1769. However, steam engines are **HUGE**, and German engine designer Karl Benz was convinced that smaller, more efficient **internal combustion engines** would do a better job.

Cugnot's vehicle had two wheels at the back, and one at the front.



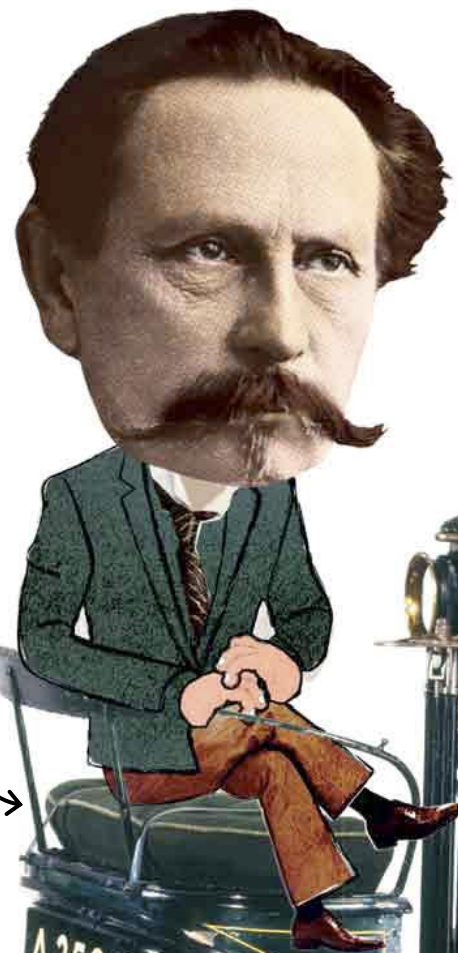
The steam boiler was at the front.

Driving the transportation **REVOLUTION**

Car

It's the four-wheeled wonder that takes us on countless journeys every day.

Benz's Patent Motorwagen No. 3 had three wheels and an engine in the rear.



In 1885, **Karl Benz** made his first automobile, which featured steel and wood panels for the body, and steel wheels covered in rubber. To demonstrate how well the new machine worked, his wife and business partner Bertha Benz **took off on the world's first long-distance car journey**, a 124-mile (200 km) round trip. During the expedition, she used a hatpin to clear a fuel line, invented brake linings, and insulated a wire with her underwear. Everyone was amazed by her adventure, and **THE CAR BECAME A SUCCESS.**

Around the Benz

It paved the way for...



MARY ANDERSON made it safer to drive in the rain when she invented the first **WINDSHIELD WIPERS** in 1903.

The first **ELECTRIC TRAFFIC LIGHTS** started controlling traffic in 1912 in Salt Lake City, invented by policeman **LESTER WIRE.**



Did you know?
The number of cars on the world's roads passed the one billion mark in 2010.